



Forlorn Oath

Monster Hunter Wilds

PC (Steam) · Game version 1.042.00.01 (August 2026)

18 mods · Fluffy Mod Manager + REFramework · Six Personnas

Compiled August 2026 — for the last version of the game

1	Installation	3
1.1	What you need	3
1.2	The mod manager: Fluffy Mod Manager 5000	3
1.2.1	Where the files live	3
1.3	Installation, step by step	3
1.4	Optional: the HDR/grading stack	4
1.5	Keeping the list alive after updates	4
1.6	Troubleshooting	5
2	The Modlist	5
2.1	The Oath's rules	5
2.2	Frameworks & tools (install first)	5
2.3	Quality of life (8)	6
2.4	Interface & information (3)	8
2.5	Visuals & clarity (4)	8
2.6	Why these mods — and what's deliberately not here	9
3	How to Play	10
3.1	The Oath's reading of the game	10
3.2	The hunt loop	10
3.3	Weather and the seasons	10
3.4	Camps: your network	11
3.5	Combat depth, beyond the basics	11
3.6	Your companions: Palico and Support Hunters	11
3.7	Progressing: Low Rank to the endgame	11
3.8	Multiplayer etiquette with the Oath	12
3.9	Ten rules for a modded hunt	12
4	Personas	12
4.1	Before you start: how "creation" works in Wilds	12
4.2	1 · The Warden of the Forlorn	13
4.3	2 · The Storm's Edge	13
4.4	3 · The Wildfire	14
4.5	4 · The Skybound Warden	14
4.6	5 · The Ember Artisan	15
4.7	6 · The Horizon Keeper	15
4.8	How to start a persona run	16

1 Installation

Everything you need to go from a vanilla install to a fully modded hunt — with the right mod manager, the right framework, and a setup that survives the game’s steady stream of updates.

1.1 What you need

- *Monster Hunter Wilds on PC (Steam)*, updated to the current build. This guide is written against **1.042.00.01** (released August 7, 2026). Steam updates automatically; check the version on the title screen before installing.
- *Fluffy Mod Manager* — the community-standard mod manager for Monster Hunter Wilds and every other RE Engine title. Download it from [Nexus Mods](#) (site-wide “Fluffy Mod Manager” page; current version 3.081). It installs, backs up, enables, and disables mods without you ever hand-editing the game folder.
- *REFramework* — the modding framework that almost every script mod in this list runs on. Download the latest **nightly build** from its [GitHub releases page](#) — the Nexus copy is frequently outdated, and an outdated `dinput8.dll` is the number one cause of black screens after a game update.
- A *Nexus Mods account* (free) — every mod in Chapter 2 is hosted on Nexus.

Good to know

This list targets the **last** version of the game as it exists today. The paid expansion *Monster Hunter Wilds: Ascendance* was announced in June 2026 for a 2027 release — it is not out yet, so none of the mods here assume it. When it lands, expect a fresh wave of updates and a new version of this guide.

1.2 The mod manager: Fluffy Mod Manager 5000

Monster Hunter Wilds mods come in two flavors: **loose-file mods** (REFramework scripts that drop into `reframework/autorun/`) and **PAK mods** (texture and asset overrides that load via REFramework’s loose-file loader). Fluffy Mod Manager handles both: you drag a downloaded archive into the window, it installs it into its own mods folder with automatic backups, and a single click enables or disables it.

Tip

Fluffy Mod Manager is the right tool for an avid modder here because it is the tool the RE Engine scene actually uses: every mod page in Chapter 2 is written against it, it keeps a pristine backup of every file it touches, and its per-mod toggles let you A/B test without touching the game folder.

1.2.1 Where the files live

- *Game folder*: `Steam\steamapps\common\MonsterHunterWilds\` — contains `MonsterHunterWilds.exe`, `dinput8.dll` (REFramework), and the `reframework\` folder.
- *REFramework scripts*: `MonsterHunterWilds\reframework\autorun\` — one `.lua` file (or subfolder) per script mod.
- *REFramework plugins*: `MonsterHunterWilds\reframework\plugins\` — `.dll` plugins such as `reframework-d2d`.
- *Fluffy’s managed mods*: Fluffy stores archives in its own `Games\MonsterHunterWilds\Mods\` folder and deploys the enabled ones into the game folder for you.

1.3 Installation, step by step

1. *Launch the game once, vanilla*. Generate your settings, confirm the build reads 1.042.00.01, and reach the title screen. This also proves your install is healthy before anything modded touches it.

2. *Install REFramework*. Download the latest nightly from [GitHub](#), extract `dinput8.dll`, and drop it next to `MonsterHunterWilds.exe`. Launch the game once — you should be able to press Insert in-game and see the REFramework menu.
3. *Enable the loose file loader*. In the REFramework menu, open **Settings** and make sure **Enable Loose File Loader** is checked. Without it, PAK-based mods (none in this list, but worth knowing) and some script features will not load.
4. *Install Fluffy Mod Manager*. Download from [Nexus](#), extract, and run `Modmanager.exe`. Pick **Monster Hunter Wilds** from the game list; point it at your Steam library if it does not find the game automatically.
5. *Install the two libraries*. Download **CatLib** ([mod 65](#)) and the overlay's renderer **REFramework Direct2D** — either the HDR-aware Wilds build ([mod 4033](#)) if you play in HDR, or the classic build from the [Rise](#) page (version 1.3.0+) otherwise. Drag each archive into Fluffy and enable it. These are dependencies, not gameplay — install them first.
6. *Install the mods from Chapter 2*. Download each archive, drag it into Fluffy Mod Manager, and enable it. The modlist chapter notes the handful that need configuration after first launch.
7. *Configure in-game*. Start the game, press Insert, and open **Script Generated UI**. That is where every REFramework script in this list exposes its options — Auto Restock, the Overlay, Disable Post Processing Effects, and the rest. Settings persist automatically.
8. *Verify*. Hunt something small. Confirm the overlay draws, weakness icons appear in the map, damage numbers render, and the image looks the way the visuals chapter intends.

Watch out

Online play with mods: Capcom has historically tolerated client-side cosmetic and information mods, but this list is designed to be played **solo or in private lobbies**. In public lobbies, disable the overlay and the damage-numbers mods before joining other hunters — showing a monster's exact HP and DPS is information the game intentionally hides, and it reads as cheating to other players even where it is not.

1.4 Optional: the HDR/grading stack

Two entries in the visuals chapter — **RenoDX** and the fog tweak — sit on top of the base install:

- **RenoDX** ([mod 202](#)) requires **ReShade with add-on support** (download from [reshade.me](#), select DirectX 12, install into the game folder). It rewrites the game's own shader pipeline — it is not a ReShade effect preset. Its virus-scan note is a known false-positive pattern from AV software; the code is open source. Install REFramework first, then ReShade, then extract RenoDX next to the game's `.exe`.
- **Tweak In-Game Volumetric Fog(s)** ([mod 455](#)) is a plain REFramework script — no extra tools. If you skip RenoDX, the base visual stack (Chapter 2) still stands on its own.

1.5 Keeping the list alive after updates

Wilds receives regular title updates, and every update is a moment your mods can break. The drill:

1. *After Steam updates the game, check the version*. If it is no longer 1.042.00.01, expect a compatibility window.
2. *Update REFramework first*. Delete `dinput8.dll`, download the newest nightly, relaunch. This fixes the majority of black screens and startup crashes on its own.
3. *Then update the scripts*. CatLib, the Overlay, and the visuals scripts are the ones that track game versions most closely (their version numbers literally mirror game patches, e.g. the weakness icons mod versions as 1.041.x).
4. *Re-test*. If something misbehaves, disable mods one at a time in Fluffy to isolate it — never assume; test.

1.6 Troubleshooting

- *Black screen or instant crash on launch* — outdated REFramework after a game update. Delete `input8.dll` (and `re_fw_config.txt`), reinstall the latest nightly from GitHub.
- *Mods not loading* — check that Enable Loose File Loader is on in the REFramework menu; confirm the script's `.lua` sits directly in `reframework\autorun\` (not in a nested folder).
- *Overlay missing* — the Overlay needs CatLib **and** a Direct2D build; if you play in HDR, the plain Rise d2d renders wrong colors, so use mod 4033. Verify all three are enabled in Fluffy.
- *Frame-gen flicker in menus* — a known quirk of the post-processing script when local exposure is on and blurred luminance is off; flip one of those two settings (see the script's own notes).
- *Still broken?* — Verify game files (Steam → right-click Monster Hunter Wilds → Properties → Installed Files → Verify integrity), then disable all mods in Fluffy and test vanilla. Re-enable one at a time.

2 The Modlist

Eighteen verified mods (seventeen required, one optional) for game version 1.042.00.01. Every entry was checked against its live Nexus Mods page (author, mod id, description, last-update date) at the time of writing. None of them make the hunt easier or hand you power — they remove busywork, reveal information, sharpen the image, and let you read the monsters better.

2.1 The Oath's rules

This list exists to deepen and modernize the experience. Every entry must earn its place against four pillars:

- *Quality of life* — remove repetition and menu busywork, never remove challenge.
- *Interface & information* — reveal what the vanilla UI hides, so decisions become informed instead of guessed.
- *Visuals & clarity* — sharper, cleaner, better-graded image.
- *Details* — the small touches that make the world and the hunt legible.

Hard exclusions: anything that changes damage, monster stats, drops, item economy, or skill numbers — those are cheats or difficulty toggles, not depth. Anything labeled “cheat” or “trainer” by its author. Anything that extends buffs, auto-plays combat, or removes the need to prepare.

Good to know

A note on “more AI”: Monster Hunter Wilds is an online game built on the RE Engine, and the community has *no stable mod that rewrites monster or Palico AI* — such mods would risk desync in multiplayer and are technically very hard. The “more AI” pillar is served honestly here in two ways: the game's own **Support Hunter** system (NPC companions you can summon — Chapter 3 explains how to use it well), and information mods that make the monsters' behavior readable (weakness icons, damage analysis, hitzone colors), so you fight *with* the AI's logic instead of against a wall of guesswork. If a real AI overhaul ever ships, it will be added here.

2.2 Frameworks & tools (install first)

The foundation every other entry stands on. These are dependencies — install them before anything else (Chapter 1 walks through the order).

REFramework

by praydog

Pillar: Foundation — the loader and scripting API

What it does: The modding framework for RE Engine games: a Lua scripting API, fixes for anti-tamper frame-time spikes, FOV/ultrawide options, freecam, timescale, and the in-game menu (Insert) where every script mod exposes its settings. Install from the nightly releases on GitHub for the newest game patches.

Why it's in the Oath: Almost every mod in this list is a REFramework script; the framework itself also removes the game's micro-stutters, which is the single biggest 'modernize the feel' win available.

Compatibility: Nexus copy lags — always use the GitHub nightly. Uninstall = delete dinput8.dll from the game folder. Updated continuously; re-install after every title update.

CatLib

by lingsamuel

Pillar: Foundation — shared utility library

What it does: A collection of shared utility scripts that the author's mods depend on. It does nothing on its own; it just needs to be present (version 1.13+, updated February 2026).

Why it's in the Oath: The dependency that unlocks the whole QoL and overlay family below — one install, many mods.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework. Install once; do not install multiple copies. Drop the `\_CatLib` folder into `reframework/autorun/`.

REFramework Direct2D

by lingsamuel (fork of cursey's reframework-d2d)

Pillar: Foundation — overlay renderer

What it does: Lets REFramework scripts draw 2D UI (health bars, text) on screen. This Wilds build adds HDR support so the overlay renders correctly on HDR displays; the classic build lives on the Rise page (mod 134, version 1.3.0+).

Why it's in the Oath: Required by MHWilds Overlay. Pick the HDR build if you play in HDR, the classic otherwise — never both.

Compatibility: `reframework-d2d.dll` → `reframework/plugins/`, `reframework-d2d.lua` → `reframework/autorun/`. Requires REFramework.

2.3 Quality of life (8)

The busywork removers. Nothing here changes a single damage number — it removes the **menus**, the **walks**, and the **waiting** between hunts so your time goes into hunting.

Auto Restock

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — preparation automation

What it does: Automatically restocks your item pouch from the item box when you accept a quest, using a loadout chosen per weapon type or per equipment set. Configure rules in Script Generated UI > Auto Restock.

Why it's in the Oath: The single most-played prep action in the game becomes a rule you set once. Preparation still matters — you still pick the loadout — but re-clicking it fifty times does not.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. Version 1.3 (December 2025).

Auto Meal

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — preparation automation

What it does: Automatically cooks and eats the meal set you configured for your current weapon or equipment loadout before a hunt — and lets you eat without consuming ingredients if you so choose.

Why it's in the Oath: Meal buffs are a real decision (which ingredients, which skills); remembering to apply them every hunt is not. The decision stays, the forgetting goes.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Auto Fix Camps

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — camp upkeep

What it does: Automatically repairs broken pop-up camps when you open the map.

Why it's in the Oath: Camp upkeep is housekeeping with no decision in it. Auto Fix Camps keeps your network of camps — and their fast-travel points — alive without a repair trip.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Auto Sharpen Weapons

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — post-hunt upkeep

What it does: Automatically sharpens your weapon after a quest ends or when you leave combat.

Why it's in the Oath: Sharpening mid-fight is a core tactical decision (do you risk the whetstone?); sharpening at camp is a chore. The mod removes only the chore.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Auto Hide Mantles

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — visual clutter

What it does: Hides the visual appearance of mantles while their effects stay fully active.

Why it's in the Oath: Mantles are some of the most visually obnoxious gear in the game; you wear them for the effect, not the look. Pure presentation, zero gameplay change.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Better Camps

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — camp capacity

What it does: Increases the maximum number of pop-up camps you can maintain, and repairs broken camps automatically after 20 seconds.

Why it's in the Oath: More camps means more fast-travel options and more map coverage — a logistics upgrade, not a combat one. You still have to place and defend them.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Skip Intro Logos

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL — launch flow

What it does: Skips the Capcom and other publisher logos on startup so the game reaches the title screen faster.

Why it's in the Oath: The least interesting thirty seconds of every session. Strictly convenience.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. See the Nexus page for the current version.

Disable Near Fade and Camera Zoom In

by lingsamuel

Pillar: QoL / camera clarity

What it does: Stops monsters, terrain, and NPCs from fading out (turning transparent) when the camera gets close, and disables the camera's automatic zoom-in during combat.

Why it's in the Oath: Large monsters up close vanish into transparency exactly when you need to read their telegraphs; the combat zoom further disorients. Both are camera behavior, not game balance — removing them makes fights readable.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework. Version 1.2.1 (April 2025). Configure via Script Generated UI > Disable Near Fade.

2.4 Interface & information (3)

These turn guessing into reading. None change a single number — they surface numbers the game already computes.

Monster Weakness Icon Indicator

by celluloid

Pillar: UI — monster knowledge

What it does: Shows each monster's elemental weaknesses as icons directly on the map and in the field guide, so you can see at a glance what to bring instead of opening the guide mid-expedition.

Why it's in the Oath: Element choice is a real preparation decision — the mod just makes the information you already own visible where you need it. Optimized for Fluffy Mod Manager usage.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework. Version mirrors the game patch (1.041.02.00, February 2026). Tagged 'fair and balanced' by the author.

MHWilds Overlay

by lingsamuel

Pillar: UI — hunt telemetry

What it does: An in-game overlay showing boss HP, per-hunter DPS, a stats table (damage, crit rate, hitzone exploitation, status buildup), and an experimental buff/damage reporter.

Why it's in the Oath: The 'modernize' flagship: the hunt becomes measurable. You can see whether your hits actually land on good hitzones, which buffs carry your damage, and whether you are actually contributing — information that turns vague hunts into learning loops.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib + REFramework + a Direct2D build. Version 1.14 (February 2026). *Multi-player honesty:* only the quest host sees full part/status detail, and DPS is accurate only for the host — one more reason to keep overlays to solo or private sessions.

Enhanced Damage Numbers

by lingsamuel

Pillar: UI — hitzone feedback

What it does: Colors your damage numbers by the real hitzone value — e.g. showing when Weakness Exploit or Mind's Eye are actually triggering — and can split physical and elemental damage into separate numbers (off by default).

Why it's in the Oath: The game's damage numbers hide *why* you hit hard or soft. This makes the hitzone system legible: you learn which parts to aim at by watching the colors, which is exactly the kind of depth this list exists to add.

Compatibility: Requires CatLib 1.6+ + REFramework. Version 1.6 (December 2025). Tested by the author in single player.

2.5 Visuals & clarity (4)

The image work. Wilds' default look is heavy on fog, lens distortion, and washed-out grading — these entries clean it up without touching gameplay.

Disable Post Processing Effects

by TonWonton

Pillar: Visuals — clarity & performance headroom

What it does: A REFramework script to toggle or tune the post-processing stack: TAA, color correction, lens distortion, local exposure, volumetric fog, film grain, sharpening, plus custom contrast and brightness for game and UI. Settings save and reload automatically.

Why it's in the Oath: The single biggest 'sharper picture' win for Wilds: it removes the blur and the washed-out grade while leaving you full control. Its defaults (lens distortion off, blurred luminance off) already clean up the image.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework. Version 1.3.3 (July 2025). Known quirk: with frame gen on, local exposure ON + blurred luminance OFF can flicker in menus — flip one of the two. Covers everything the stand-alone lens-distortion mod does, so that mod is not needed.

Tweak In-Game Volumetric Fog(s)

by TheFuzzy

Pillar: Visuals — atmosphere tuning

What it does: Lets you tune the volumetric fog's resolution, ambient light, fog culling distance, and near-fade distance — reducing the fog's obscuring effect *without* switching it off entirely.

Why it's in the Oath: Wilds' fog is beautiful but heavy-handed: it hides monsters that are 40 meters away. This keeps the atmosphere while returning visibility — the 'details' pillar in one slider set.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework (build 01090+). Version 1.0.0 (March 2025). Works alongside Disable Post Processing Effects; recommended companion by both authors.

Persistent Buff Glow Removal

by Peasly Wellbott

Pillar: Visuals — effect clutter

What it does: Configurably suppresses the pulsing glow effects on your hunter from item buffs, skills, weapons, and mantles — plus optional hiding of blights, frenzy effects, and elemental hit flashes.

Why it's in the Oath: Buff glows are the visual noise of every hunt. With it off by default for the worst offenders and fully configurable, you see the monster, not your own aura.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework. Version 2.0.3 (July 2025). Options live in Script Generated UI; per-effect toggles, default False for most.

RenoDX — HDR and SDR Fix (optional)

by Ritsu and Kickfister

Pillar: Visuals — grading pipeline

What it does: Rewrites the game's DX12 grading pipeline to fix Wilds' raised blacks and narrow dynamic range in both HDR and SDR, adding real-time controls for tonemapping, paper white, UI brightness, exposure, contrast, and color grading.

Why it's in the Oath: The deep-end visual fix: the game's own color pipeline is the weakest link in its image quality, and this is the only mod that replaces it properly. Optional because it needs ReShade's add-on system and is for players who care about the image enough to tune it.

Compatibility: Requires REFramework + ReShade with add-on support (reshade.me, DirectX 12). Version 4.4.2 (August 2026) — actively maintained. AV may flag the DLL (known false positive; open source). Do not stack with other engine-level shader mods — see the page's troubleshooting.

2.6 Why these mods — and what's deliberately not here

- *No difficulty mods.* Nothing that multiplies monster HP or damage. Challenge in Wilds comes from the hunt itself, not from a slider; the list deepens the game rather than inflating it.
- *No cheats.* No infinite consumables, free crafting, editors, or item injection — those are explicitly outside the Oath.
- *No buff extenders.* Pausing meal timers or extending item buffs would quietly make the game easier; preparation is part of the game.
- *No weapon-moveset tweaks.* A handful of popular mods unlock movesets or remove input delays for specific weapons — they change combat balance per weapon and are out of scope.
- *No dead or redundant entries.* The DirectStorage DLL swap (marked “no longer necessary” by its author), the standalone lens-distortion mod (fully covered by Disable Post Processing Effects), and the “Lite Environment” performance pack (end of support) were all evaluated and rejected at compile time.

3 How to Play

This chapter assumes you know the shape of *Monster Hunter* but want to play Wilds **well** with the Oath installed — how to read the game with the mods' new information, and the systems that actually matter.

3.1 The Oath's reading of the game

The mods are not decoration — they change how you make decisions:

- *Weakness icons* tell you what to bring before you leave camp. Element choice stops being a guess.
- *The Overlay* tells you how the fight is actually going: which hunter is doing what, what percentage of your damage lands on real hitzones, and when a monster is about to die — so you can stop over-cautious play and commit.
- *Enhanced Damage Numbers* teach you the hitzone system live: gold numbers where Weakness Exploit triggers, split physical/elemental values when you turn that on. You learn the monster's weak parts by watching your own hits.
- *The visual stack* (post-processing script, fog tweak, glow removal) means you can actually **see** the monster's telegraphs at distance and in weather. Read the tells, not the fog.
- *The QoL stack* removes the between-hunt busywork — restock, meal, camp repair, sharpening — so your session is hunts, not menus.

Good to know

Nothing in the Oath makes a monster die faster or hit softer. The information edge is real, but it is a **skill** edge: the mods show you what is already happening and let you act on it. Play with them for a week and you will be a better hunter — unmodded too, because everything you learned was already in the game.

3.2 The hunt loop

Every hunt in Wilds runs the same skeleton. The mods slot into it:

1. *Prepare*. Eat a meal (Auto Meal handles it from your configured set), confirm your item loadout (Auto Restock restocks it when you take the quest). Check the weakness icons on the map to confirm your element.
2. *Travel*. Call your Seikret. Mark the monster on the map and let auto-navigation carry you — use the ride to sharpen (Auto Sharpen already handled the camp side) and plan your opening.
3. *Track*. Follow the Scoutflies and the monster's trail. Wilds' monsters move between zones; the map shows their current position and direction.
4. *Engage*. Enter Focus Mode to aim attacks at wounds and weak parts. The damage numbers now tell you where you are actually hitting — follow the gold.
5. *Exploit*. Wounds glow red (blue on tempered monsters). A **Focus Strike** on a wound deals bonus damage, breaks it, and usually rewards you with parts or a resource refund. This is Wilds' core combat loop — wound, strike, repeat.
6. *Finish*. Slay or capture. The Overlay's HP bar removes the ambiguity of "is it dying?" — when it limps, it is time to decide: trap, or finish the carve.

3.3 Weather and the seasons

Every locale cycles through three states, and the state is a strategy layer:

- *Plenty* — abundant resources, calmer monsters. The best time to gather and farm.
- *Fallow* — dry and sparse; some monsters and resources withdraw.
- *Inclemency* — storms, sandstorms, magma flows. This is when **Apex monsters** appear and the environment itself becomes a hazard. The strongest hunts happen here.

You can change the weather and time of day by resting at a camp and using the BBQ menu — it costs Guild Points, so it is a resource decision, not a freebie. The fog and post-processing mods matter most in Inclemency: with the fog tamed, you can actually fight the apex in its storm instead of guessing where it is.

3.4 Camps: your network

- *Base camps* are permanent hubs: item box, smithy access, tent (change equipment, appearance, and loadouts).
- *Pop-up camps* are built with a Camping Kit at marked spots. Each gives a fast-travel point and a rest stop — and monsters can destroy them. Better Camps raises how many you can maintain and Auto Fix Camps repairs them when you open the map.

Tip

Build pop-up camps near the hunting grounds you farm. A camp on the far side of the locale is worth more than a second camp near base — fast-travel is the difference between a fifteen-minute chase and a five-minute hunt.

3.5 Combat depth, beyond the basics

- *Focus Mode* (hold the aim button) gives precise attack direction, lets you guard in any direction, and reveals wounds. It is not optional tech — it is the game's central combat system.
- *Offset attacks* — certain weapon moves, timed against an incoming attack, trigger a clash-like counter. High-risk, high-reward reads.
- *Clashes* — blocking a monster's charge with a heavy weapon can lock into a power struggle; winning it topples the monster.
- *Mounting and the Seikret* — while mounted you can use items, sharpen, and switch to your second weapon. The Seikret can sprint, drift, and glide; its auto-navigation frees your attention for the map and the monster.
- *The 14 weapons* — every one is viable. At camp, the training area lets you try all of them with zero commitment; take a few hunts per weapon to find your two (the Seikret carries a second weapon, so you can build a two-weapon identity).

3.6 Your companions: Palico and Support Hunters

- *The Palico* is your permanent partner: heals, buffs, traps, and distracts. Its behavior is not moddable — instead, you shape it through its equipment and abilities.
- *Support Hunters* are NPC hunters who fill your party when you start a quest solo. They split aggro and can make a hard hunt manageable — and monster HP scales with them, so it is not free.

Good to know

This is the Oath's honest answer to "more AI": the game ships two AI companion systems, and the mods make the **monsters'** AI readable. For the true solo experience, hunt without Support Hunters; for a living party without multiplayer, summon them — and treat them as allies whose aggro you should read and use, not as a difficulty slider.

3.7 Progressing: Low Rank to the endgame

- *Low Rank* (the story): the Forlorn expedition's journey through the Forbidden Lands. The story walks you through every locale and system — follow it, it is the tutorial in disguise.
- *High Rank*: after the credits, the real game. New variants, investigations, and the start of buildcraft. This is where the Overlay's stats table earns its keep — you can finally see which of your skills actually produce damage.

- *Tempered monsters* — stronger variants with glowing wounds (blue in Focus Mode). The endgame's bread and butter.
- *Arch-Tempered* — the top-tier challenge variants added through title updates (Arch-Tempered Rey Dau, Uth Duna, Arkveld, and more). Expect the hardest hunts in the game; bring the whole Oath stack.
- *Investigations* — randomized quests with modifiers that change rewards and difficulty. The endgame's farming loop.
- *Event quests* — since the 1.042 update, all 26 event quests are playable offline. Farm them for exclusive gear and layered armor without a lobby.

Content released so far through title updates: Mizutsune, Lagiocrus, Seregios, Gogmazios, and various Arch-Tempered and collaboration quests, on top of the launch roster. The **Ascendancy** expansion is coming in 2027 — until then, this is the complete game, and this list is built for it.

3.8 Multiplayer etiquette with the Oath

- *Solo and private lobbies*: run everything. The Overlay, damage numbers, the full visual stack — all fine.
- *Public lobbies*: disable the Overlay and Enhanced Damage Numbers before joining others (one click in Fluffy Mod Manager, or their REFramework toggles). The game hides monster HP for a reason; other players did not consent to you seeing theirs. The QoL and visuals mods are client-side and harmless.
- *With friends*: use a private lobby and share the overlay data — comparing DPS charts after a hunt is half the fun.

3.9 Ten rules for a modded hunt

1. *Update REFramework after every game update, before anything else.* Black screen = old dinput8.dll, nine times out of ten.
2. *Keep the Oath's exclusions in mind* — if a mod sounds like it removes challenge, it does not belong.
3. *Eat before every hunt* (Auto Meal makes this automatic — configure the sets).
4. *Restock before every hunt* (Auto Restock — configure per weapon type).
5. *Read the damage numbers* — gold means Weakness Exploit is live; if you are hitting grey, you are hitting the wrong part.
6. *Fight the weather, don't fight the fog* — with the fog tamed, Inclemency is where the best hunts live.
7. *Capture when you need parts, slay when you need carves* — the Overlay's HP bar makes the decision clean.
8. *Learn two weapons* — the Seikret carries a second; a ranged and a melee identity covers every matchup.
9. *One persona, one save* (Chapter 4) — keep the chronicles from bleeding into each other.
10. *Screenshot the moments* — with the image stack, Wilds is a beautiful game; the Oath just takes the glasses off.

4 Personas

Who are you in the Forbidden Lands? Six ways to play the same modded world — each with a background, and the character-creation choices that make it yours.

4.1 Before you start: how “creation” works in Wilds

Monster Hunter Wilds has no difficulty slider and no class system — your identity comes from the **character creator** and the rules you keep. At creation you choose:

- *The hunter* — name, voice and pitch, posture, skin tone, facial structure, hair (color, gradients, length), eyebrows, eyes, nose, mouth, skin textures (wrinkles, scars), makeup and face paint. Fully editable later at any camp's tent; the deeper edit vouchers live on the title screen.
- *The Palico* — name, fur pattern and colors, ear shapes, eye designs, and voice (traditional Felyne language, or spoken language with your choice of pitch).

- *The Seikret* — name, colors, feather patterns, and decorations. Your mount is your identity on the road.
- *The weapon* — all fourteen are available from the start; the training area at camp lets you try any of them. Each persona leads with one and carries a second on the Seikret.
- *Character creation codes* — the creator is so detailed that players share “recipe” codes; you can paste one in at creation to start from someone else’s look. If you find a face you love for a persona, use its code.

Good to know

All six personas run on the **same** modlist — the personas differ in creation choices, weapons, and self-imposed rules, not in mods. Wilds’ challenge comes from the monster, your gear, and the rules you keep, so each persona’s “house rules” are the real character. Keep one save per persona so you can always return to an old chronicle.

4.2 1 • The Warden of the Forlorn

The Warden of the Forlorn *Weapons: Lance → Gunlance · Focus: standing your ground*

Background. The expedition does not travel because it is safe; it travels because someone holds the line. The Warden is that someone — the veteran who planted the first flag, the hunter who walks into a monster’s charge instead of out of it. Lance is the identity: guard, counter, and the patience to let a monster exhaust itself against your shield. Gunlance is the second act: when patience stops being enough, the shelling starts. The Warden measures a hunt in how few steps they took backwards.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** a weathered face with visible scars (skin texture slider), short practical hair, deep voice, low pitch. Name them after a landmark — **Kestrel, Monolith, Barricade**.
- **Palico:** sturdy build, thick fur, a calm eye; name them **Vigil**. Spoken voice, low pitch — a steady presence, not a comedian.
- **Seikret:** earthen tones — dun and slate with minimal decoration. A workhorse mount, not a show pony.
- **Weapons:** start Lance; add Gunlance as the Seikret’s second weapon once you own the basics.
- **House rules:** never roll out of a monster’s attack — block, counter, or take it on the shield; guard the camp — a quest does not end until every Support Hunter stands; at least one Clash won per major hunt.
- **Goal:** every Apex and Arch-Tempered, standing your ground the whole fight.
- **Mods that shine:** Disable Near Fade (see the monster coming, always), the Overlay (know exactly when the monster is about to fall), Persistent Buff Glow Removal (keep your shield read clean), the visual stack.

4.3 2 • The Storm’s Edge

The Storm’s Edge *Weapons: Long Sword → Great Sword · Focus: reading monsters, perfect counters*

Background. Every monster is a language of wind-ups and tells, and the Storm’s Edge speaks it fluently. Long Sword is the conversation: Iai sheathe, counter, Spirit Blade — offense that is really a series of **reads**. The Great Sword is the punctuation: one charged slash placed exactly where the monster’s move leaves it open. The Storm’s Edge hunts slowly and kills quickly: most of the hunt is watching, most of the fight is three perfect hits.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** sharp, angular features; dark hair with a single streak of color (hair gradient slider); medium voice, calm pitch. Name them for weather — **Monsoon, Squall, Kestrel**.
- **Palico:** sleek, dark fur with bright eyes; name them **Flicker**. Felyne language — tradition suits the duelist.
- **Seikret:** storm colors — slate blue and white feathers, lightning-pattern decoration.

- **Weapons:** start Long Sword; carry Great Sword as the second.
- **House rules:** every hunt must include at least one perfect Iai counter and one Offset attack — reads are the point; never use the auto-navigation to chase — walk the monster's own path so you learn its routes; no healing while the monster is enraged (you read it, you own it).
- **Goal:** slay every monster with fewer than N hits taken — the Overlay's stats prove it.
- **Mods that shine:** the Overlay (DPS and hit data prove your reads), Enhanced Damage Numbers (hitzone colors show where the counters should land), Disable Near Fade (see the tell, not the fade), the fog tweak.

4.4 3 • The Wildfire

The Wildfire *Weapons: Dual Blades → Sword & Shield · Focus: relentless aggression, flinches and wounds*

Background. Some hunters study the monster; the Wildfire **overwhelms** it. Dual Blades is a machine-gun of damage that lives on the monster's weak spot and converts every opening into a wound; Sword & Shield is the flexible second gear — item use without sheathing, guard when needed, and the best mounting game in the roster. The Wildfire's philosophy: the monster cannot use its best moves if it never gets a turn. The Overlay exists for this persona — watching the DPS chart climb is the sport.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** a young, bright face with face paint (asymmetry slider off — clean, bold marks); short, vivid hair (bright gradient); energetic voice, higher pitch. Name them for fire — **Blaze, Ember, Cinder**.
- **Palico:** small, orange fur with a white blaze; name them **Spark**. Spoken voice, bright pitch.
- **Seikret:** flame colors — red-orange feathers with gold decoration.
- **Weapons:** start Dual Blades; carry Sword & Shield for mounts and flex matchups.
- **House rules:** stay in the monster's face — leaving the immediate melee range without a reason counts as a failed rule; create at least one wound per minute of combat; never let the weapon's sharpness drop below the middle bar mid-fight (Auto Sharpen only works between hunts — the Wildfire must manage it live).
- **Goal:** top the damage chart in every hunt — alone, with Support Hunters, or with friends in a private lobby.
- **Mods that shine:** the Overlay (the scoreboard), Enhanced Damage Numbers (the feedback loop), Auto Restock (never stop for items), the visual stack for clarity at speed.

4.5 4 • The Skybound Warden

The Skybound Warden *Weapons: Insect Glaive → Hunting Horn · Focus: aerial mastery, extracts, and the field guide*

Background. The expedition's naturalist, armed. The Insect Glaive puts the Skybound Warden above the monster — harvesting extracts with the kinsect, vaulting over attacks, and reading the fight from the air, where the pattern is clearest. The Hunting Horn is the support identity: songs that make the whole party stronger, because the Warden believes the expedition is one creature. This is the persona for hunters who want to **understand** monsters — every hunt is a field study.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** a curious, open face with light freckles or a faint sun-mark; tousled hair; warm voice, mid pitch. Name them for the sky — **Crane, Lark, Zenith**.
- **Palico:** soft, cream-colored fur, big eyes; name them **Moth**. Felyne language — they have their own research.

- **Seikret:** pale feathers with sky-blue tips, feather-pattern pendant.
- **Weapons:** start Insect Glaive; add Hunting Horn as the second for multiplayer hunts and hard walls.
- **House rules:** keep all three extracts up before engaging — no fights without the full trio; complete the field guide for every monster you hunt (weakness icons make this a checklist, not a chore); use the Support Hunter party at least once per session — the Warden hunts with the expedition.
- **Goal:** a complete field guide and a library of solo kills on every flying monster.
- **Mods that shine:** Monster Weakness Icon Indicator (the field guide at a glance), the Overlay (extract uptime and status buildup readouts), Better Camps (a camp network for the naturalist's routes).

4.6 5 • The Ember Artisan

The Ember Artisan *Weapons: Charge Blade → Switch Axe · Focus: technical mastery and the forge*

Background. The smithy's finest student, sent into the field to test what the forge makes. The Charge Blade is a machine of two halves — sword-and-shield charging phials, axe mode spending them — and mastering it is an apprenticeship in itself. Switch Axe is the second trade: morphing, phial management, and the explosive axe-mode finishers. The Ember Artisan fights like they forge: deliberate, hot, and precise. Gemma the smith approves of this persona.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** a soot-smudged look (skin texture slider), strong jaw, hair tied back; low, measured voice. Name them for the forge — **Anvil, Bracket, Temper.**
- **Palico:** charcoal fur with amber eyes; name them **Slag.** Spoken voice, dry and low.
- **Seikret:** ember tones — deep brown with orange pattern, metal pendant.
- **Weapons:** start Charge Blade; carry Switch Axe for variety.
- **House rules:** every hunt must end with the weapon fully discharged — never leave phials unspent; craft at least one piece of gear from every monster you slay (the forge is the point); learn one new weapon combo per session in the training area.
- **Goal:** a fully upgraded weapon and armor set from every title-update monster — the artisan's catalogue.
- **Mods that shine:** Enhanced Damage Numbers (see phial damage vs. raw — the artisan's data), the Overlay (status buildup readout for phial decisions), Auto Meal (the forge runs on meals), the visual stack to admire the crafted gear.

4.7 6 • The Horizon Keeper

The Horizon Keeper *Weapons: Bow → Light Bowgun · Focus: the expedition's surveyor — exploration, gathering, weather*

Background. The expedition does not only hunt — it **maps**. The Horizon Keeper is the surveyor who knows every locale's weather cycle, every camp site, every gathering node worth a detour. Bow is the ranged identity: positioning, range discipline, and the patience of a shot held until the monster offers it. Light Bowgun is the second register — statuses and support shots from a safe distance. The Horizon Keeper wins hunts before they start: the right element, the right camp, the right weather, and a route that wastes nothing.

Creation choices

- **Hunter:** a sun-weathered face, practical short hair, calm eyes; even voice, mid-low pitch. Name them for the horizon — **Meridian, Farpoint, Bearing.**
- **Palico:** tawny fur, alert ears; name them **Compass.** Felyne language.
- **Seikret:** sand-and-sky colors — pale feathers with blue accents, utility pendant.
- **Weapons:** start Bow; carry Light Bowgun for status work.

- **House rules:** check the weather before every hunt and pick the right Inclemency for apex hunts; place a new pop-up camp in a locale you have not built in yet each session; gather on the way — every hunt route includes at least three gathering stops; use the weakness icons to plan the element **before** leaving camp.
- **Goal:** every camp site built in every locale, the field guide completed, and a solo bow kill of every Apex in its own Inclemency storm.
- **Mods that shine:** Monster Weakness Icon Indicator (planning), Better Camps + Auto Fix Camps (the surveyor's network), the fog tweak (see the apex through the storm), Auto Restock (loadout per weapon type — the surveyor's preps).

4.8 How to start a persona run

1. *Create the character* with the persona's choices above (or paste a matching creation code at creation).
2. *Name the save* forlorn-<persona> so the chronicles stay separate.
3. *Write the house rules on paper* — three lines of rules beat a forgotten promise in hour forty.
4. *Configure the QoL mods* for the persona's weapons — Auto Restock and Auto Meal loadouts per weapon type (Script Generated UI), so each persona's preparation is automatic and distinct.
5. *Hunt.* The first hunt with a new persona is the tutorial for that identity; the hundredth is the chronicle.

<i>Persona</i>	<i>Weapons</i>	<i>Signature mods</i>
The Warden of the Forlorn	Lance / Gunlance	Disable Near Fade, Overlay, Persistent Buff Glow Removal
The Storm's Edge	Long Sword / Great Sword	Overlay, Enhanced Damage Numbers, Disable Near Fade, fog tweak
The Wildfire	Dual Blades / Sword & Shield	Overlay, Enhanced Damage Numbers, Auto Restock
The Skybound Warden	Insect Glaive / Hunting Horn	Weakness Icons, Overlay, Better Camps
The Ember Artisan	Charge Blade / Switch Axe	Enhanced Damage Numbers, Overlay, Auto Meal
The Horizon Keeper	Bow / Light Bowgun	Weakness Icons, Better Camps, Auto Fix Camps, fog tweak